



Things change if you log out

Elon Musk has made changes Twitter's homepage for the logged-out users.
<https://digit.in/nov22-33>



My country, my rules

IT Amendment Rules 2022 have tightened the reins on social media companies.
<https://digit.in/nov22-34>

Realme Buds Air 3S

Adequate for the price

Realme has stepped into the Indian market and has made its mark by making quality products across categories. However, Realme is not the only brand that is active in that space and brands like Oppo, Xiaomi, and One Plus too are trying their best to make their mark when it comes to budget True Wireless Earbuds. So when the Realme Buds Air 3S, a pair of budget TWS earbuds which are retailing in the market at the time of writing for ₹1,999 (launch price - ₹2,499), we put them through their paces to find out where they stand in this overly crowded headphone price segment.

BUILD

Realme Buds Air 3S are a treat to look at. Our black coloured review unit looked gorgeous when we first pulled it out of its box. The lid of the case was translucent giving a nice peek into the charging case, which had a grey coloured housing to hold the headphones in place. The housing had a matte finish, with the Realme logo subtly placed below the charging indicator LED, and the company's slogan - Dare To Leap, printed on a slightly raised bump on the top half of the case.

The hinge did not have a metal support bracket, a feature which is always appreciated, and is a regular feature on some of the TWS cases that score some of the highest points in the build quality department. The earbuds themselves were pretty to look at, and easy to wear for extended periods of time. The short stem had a glossy black tinted finish which added a subtle bling to the otherwise relatively muted design. They sport a small wing that adds to the grip of the earbuds inside the earlobe, and the three different sizes of tips generally cover all the different bases. One gripe that we had with these TWS earbuds was the glossy finish of the plastics. While it looks awesome during the early



stages of use, when the earbuds have been taken out of the box, the finish just deteriorates very quickly.

FEATURES

When talking about features, the buds are not packed with features like some of its competitors in the market.

You get great touch-sensitive controls on the stem, both visual and audio indicators of the battery level of the device, and a good collection of customisation options in the app. The controls can also be customised to a certain extent, but there is not much flexibility here. There is Dolby Atmos support too, meaning that high quality audio files will be reproduced well by the 11mm liquid silicone triple titanium bass drivers that it comes packed with. We liked that the instant pairing which worked like a charm with Android devices. But, when it was the turn of the iOS devices, it had its share of hiccups. While the AI noise cancellation worked well in most environments, in challenging environments, all the hype came crashing on the floor.

PERFORMANCE

Performance is one section where most budget TWs earbuds tend to fall apart

and show their true colours. With these earbuds, the bass was boosted. This is something that we expected. But, as we moved to the mids, their sound signature, to our surprise, very close to the flat response of the pink noise that we use as a standard in our tests. The highs in some sections were overemphasised, before falling down, and then rising again. But then again, in the sub 3k price bracket, there are hardly any earbuds that would give us that sound signature.

BATTERY

During the battery tests, the Realme Buds Air 3S faired decently well. The buds during our test lasted for about 6 hours and 50 minutes. During the test, the volume level was set to 50 per cent and the lack of ANC meant that they fell just shy of the claimed 7 hour mark. For charging, these earbuds sport a USB C port which supports fast charging.

VERDICT

After thoroughly testing the Realme Buds Air 3S and comparing them with their rivals, we can

safely say that they are a decent overall package. They sport a decent build quality and pack features that you can rely on. The only downside, which may be a deal breaker for many, is the bass heavy sound signature that you get out of the box. If you want to look for other options in the price range, then offerings from OnePlus and Oppo, like the Nord Buds and the Enco Buds2 are the way to go.

—Sativik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

COLOURS: Bass Black/Bass White | NOISE REDUCTION: 4-mic design AI ANC noise reduction | BATTERY LIFE: Case+Buds: 30 hours, Buds alone: 7 hours playback, 4 hours calling | SOUND DRIVER: 11mm liquid silicone triple titanium bass driver | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.3 | CHARGING TIME: Case+Buds: 120 minutes, Buds alone: 60 minutes | WIRELESS RANGE: 10m | WATER RESISTANCE RATING: IPX5 (earbuds only) | AUDIO CODECS: AAC, SBC

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